Heirloom Home Kitchen

20 Classic American Recipes

A collection of beloved home recipes drawn from the American kitchen tradition — the dishes passed down through generations, made from simple ingredients, and served at family tables across the country.

Public Domain Collection

Buttermilk Biscuits

Yield: 12 biscuits • Prep: 15 minutes • Cook: 12 minutes

Ingredients:

— 2 cups all-purpose flour
— 1 tablespoon baking powder
— 1/4 teaspoon baking soda
— 1 teaspoon salt
— 1 teaspoon sugar
— 6 tablespoons cold unsalted butter, cut into small cubes
— 3/4 cup cold buttermilk

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 450 degrees F. Line a baking sheet with parchment paper.
2. Whisk together the flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and sugar in a large bowl.
3. Add the cold butter cubes. Using your fingertips, work the butter into the flour until the mixture resembles coarse crumbs with some pea-sized pieces remaining.
4. Pour in the cold buttermilk and stir gently with a fork until the dough just comes together. Do not overmix.
5. Turn the dough onto a lightly floured surface and pat it to 3/4-inch thickness. Fold the dough in half and pat again to 3/4 inch.
6. Cut out rounds with a 2 1/2-inch biscuit cutter, pressing straight down without twisting.
7. Place the biscuits on the prepared baking sheet so they are touching. Bake for 10 to 12 minutes, until golden brown on top.
8. Serve warm with butter and honey.

Note:

Keep all ingredients as cold as possible for the flakiest biscuits. Leftover biscuits keep at room temperature for up to 2 days.

Chicken and Dumplings

Yield: 6 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 1 hour

Ingredients:

— 3 pounds bone-in, skin-on chicken pieces
— 8 cups low-sodium chicken broth
— 2 medium carrots, sliced into rounds
— 2 stalks celery, sliced
— 1 medium onion, diced
— 2 cloves garlic, minced
— 1 teaspoon dried thyme
— 1 bay leaf
— Salt and black pepper to taste
— 2 cups all-purpose flour
— 1 tablespoon baking powder
— 1 teaspoon salt
— 1 cup whole milk
— 3 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted

Instructions:

1. Place the chicken pieces in a large pot or Dutch oven. Add the broth, carrots, celery, onion, garlic, thyme, and bay leaf.
2. Bring to a boil over high heat, then reduce heat to medium-low. Simmer for 35 to 40 minutes, until the chicken is cooked through and very tender.
3. Remove the chicken pieces and set aside to cool slightly. Remove and discard the bay leaf.
4. When the chicken is cool enough to handle, shred the meat and discard the skin and bones. Return the shredded chicken to the pot.
5. Season the broth with salt and pepper. Keep at a gentle simmer.
6. Make the dumplings: whisk together the flour, baking powder, and salt in a bowl. Stir in the milk and melted butter until a soft dough forms. Do not overmix.

7. Drop the dumpling dough by heaping tablespoons into the simmering broth. Cover the pot tightly and cook for 15 minutes without lifting the lid.
8. Serve hot, ladling broth, chicken, vegetables, and dumplings into each bowl.

Note:

Do not lift the lid while the dumplings cook or they will be dense. The dumplings should be fluffy and cooked through.

Sunday Pot Roast

Yield: 6 to 8 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 3 hours 30 minutes

Ingredients:

— 3 to 4 pounds beef chuck roast
— 2 teaspoons salt
— 1 teaspoon black pepper
— 2 tablespoons vegetable oil
— 1 large onion, cut into wedges
— 4 cloves garlic, smashed
— 3 medium carrots, cut into 2-inch pieces
— 3 stalks celery, cut into 2-inch pieces
— 1 pound small Yukon gold potatoes, halved
— 2 cups beef broth
— 1 tablespoon Worcestershire sauce
— 2 sprigs fresh thyme
— 1 sprig fresh rosemary

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 325 degrees F. Pat the roast dry with paper towels and season all over with salt and pepper.
2. Heat the oil in a large Dutch oven over high heat. Sear the roast for 4 to 5 minutes per side until deeply browned. Transfer to a plate.
3. Reduce heat to medium. Add the onion and garlic to the pot and cook, stirring, for 3 minutes.
4. Return the roast to the pot. Add the beef broth, Worcestershire sauce, thyme, and rosemary.
5. Bring to a simmer, then cover tightly and transfer to the oven. Cook for 2 hours.
6. Add the carrots, celery, and potatoes around the roast. Re-cover and return to the oven for 1 to 1 1/2 hours more, until the beef is very tender and pulls apart easily.
7. Transfer the roast and vegetables to a serving platter. Skim fat from the cooking liquid and serve the juices alongside.

Note:

Chuck roast is the ideal cut for pot roast — its marbling and connective tissue break down into rich, silky braising liquid.

Classic Apple Pie

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 40 minutes • Cook: 1 hour

Ingredients:

— 2 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
— 1 teaspoon salt
— 1 tablespoon sugar
— 1 cup cold unsalted butter, cut into 1/2-inch cubes
— 6 to 8 tablespoons ice water
— 3 pounds tart apples, such as Granny Smith, peeled, cored, and sliced 1/4-inch thick
— 3/4 cup sugar
— 2 tablespoons all-purpose flour
— 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
— 1/4 teaspoon ground nutmeg
— 1/4 teaspoon salt
— 2 tablespoons unsalted butter, cut into small pieces
— 1 egg, beaten with 1 tablespoon water (egg wash)

Instructions:

1. Make the pie crust: combine the flour, salt, and sugar in a large bowl. Add the cold butter and work it in with your fingers until the mixture resembles coarse meal with some larger pieces.
2. Add ice water one tablespoon at a time, stirring gently after each addition, just until the dough holds together when pressed. Divide in half, shape into discs, wrap in plastic, and refrigerate for at least 1 hour.
3. Preheat the oven to 425 degrees F.
4. Make the filling: toss the sliced apples with the sugar, flour, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt in a large bowl until evenly coated.
5. Roll out one disc of dough on a floured surface to a 12-inch circle. Transfer to a 9-inch pie plate and trim the edge, leaving a 1-inch overhang.
6. Add the apple filling, mounding it slightly in the center. Dot with the butter pieces.

7. Roll out the second disc of dough. Lay it over the filling, trim to a 1-inch overhang, then fold both edges under and crimp to seal. Cut several steam vents in the top crust. Brush with egg wash.
8. Bake for 20 minutes, then reduce heat to 375 degrees F and bake for 35 to 40 minutes more, until the crust is golden and the filling is bubbling.
9. Cool on a wire rack for at least 2 hours before slicing.

Note:

A mix of apple varieties adds depth. Store the pie loosely covered at room temperature for up to 2 days.

Cast Iron Skillet Cornbread

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 10 minutes • Cook: 20 minutes

Ingredients:

— 1 cup yellow cornmeal
— 1 cup all-purpose flour
— 1 tablespoon baking powder
— 1/2 teaspoon baking soda
— 1 teaspoon salt
— 2 tablespoons sugar
— 2 eggs, lightly beaten
— 1 cup buttermilk
— 1/4 cup sour cream
— 1/4 cup unsalted butter, melted and cooled
— 1 tablespoon vegetable oil or bacon drippings

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 425 degrees F. Place a 10-inch cast iron skillet in the oven while it heats.
2. Whisk together the cornmeal, flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and sugar in a large bowl.
3. In a separate bowl, whisk together the eggs, buttermilk, sour cream, and melted butter.
4. Pour the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients and stir just until combined. A few lumps are fine.
5. Carefully remove the hot skillet from the oven. Add the oil or bacon drippings and swirl to coat the bottom and sides.
6. Pour the batter into the hot skillet. It should sizzle.
7. Bake for 18 to 22 minutes, until the top is golden and a toothpick inserted in the center comes out clean.
8. Let cool in the skillet for 5 minutes, then cut into wedges and serve warm.

Note:

Heating the skillet before adding the batter creates a crisp, golden crust. This cornbread pairs beautifully with chili or soups.

Hearty Beef Stew

Yield: 6 servings • Prep: 25 minutes • Cook: 2 hours

Ingredients:

— 2 pounds beef stew meat, cut into 1 1/2-inch cubes
— 1/3 cup all-purpose flour
— 1 teaspoon salt
— 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
— 3 tablespoons vegetable oil
— 1 large onion, chopped
— 3 cloves garlic, minced
— 2 tablespoons tomato paste
— 1 cup dry red wine or additional beef broth
— 3 cups low-sodium beef broth
— 1 pound Yukon gold potatoes, cut into 1-inch pieces
— 3 medium carrots, sliced into 1-inch rounds
— 2 stalks celery, sliced
— 1 teaspoon dried thyme
— 2 bay leaves
— 2 tablespoons fresh parsley, chopped

Instructions:

1. Toss the beef cubes with the flour, salt, and pepper until lightly coated.
2. Heat the oil in a large Dutch oven over medium-high heat. Brown the beef in batches, 3 to 4 minutes per side. Do not crowd the pot. Transfer browned pieces to a plate.
3. Add the onion to the pot and cook for 4 minutes, scraping up the browned bits. Add the garlic and tomato paste and cook 1 minute more.
4. Pour in the wine and stir to deglaze the pot. Add the broth, thyme, and bay leaves.
5. Return the browned beef and any accumulated juices to the pot. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat to low. Cover and simmer for 1 hour.
6. Add the potatoes, carrots, and celery. Re-cover and simmer for 45 minutes to 1 hour more, until the beef and vegetables are very tender.

7. Remove the bay leaves. Taste and adjust seasoning. Garnish with fresh parsley before serving.

Note:

The stew improves with time. Make it a day ahead and reheat gently for an even richer flavor.

Baked Macaroni and Cheese

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 30 minutes

Ingredients:

— 1 pound elbow macaroni
— 4 tablespoons unsalted butter
— 1/4 cup all-purpose flour
— 3 cups whole milk, warmed
— 1 cup half-and-half
— 2 teaspoons dry mustard
— 1/2 teaspoon garlic powder
— 1/2 teaspoon onion powder
— 1/2 teaspoon salt
— 1/4 teaspoon black pepper
— 3 cups sharp cheddar cheese, shredded
— 1 cup Gruyere cheese, shredded
— 1 cup panko breadcrumbs
— 2 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 375 degrees F. Butter a 9x13-inch baking dish.
2. Cook the macaroni in salted boiling water until just short of al dente, about 2 minutes less than the package directions. Drain and set aside.
3. Melt the butter in a large saucepan over medium heat. Whisk in the flour and cook, whisking constantly, for 2 minutes.
4. Gradually whisk in the warm milk and half-and-half. Cook, stirring frequently, until the sauce thickens and coats the back of a spoon, about 8 minutes.
5. Remove from heat. Stir in the dry mustard, garlic powder, onion powder, salt, and pepper. Add 2 1/2 cups of the cheddar and all of the Gruyere, stirring until melted.
6. Add the drained pasta to the cheese sauce and stir to combine. Pour into the prepared baking dish.

7. Combine the panko with the melted butter and remaining 1/2 cup cheddar. Sprinkle evenly over the top.
8. Bake for 25 to 30 minutes, until the top is golden and the sauce is bubbling around the edges. Let rest for 5 minutes before serving.

Note:

Shredding cheese from a block melts much smoother than pre-shredded bags, which contain anti-caking agents.

Old-Fashioned Banana Bread

Yield: 1 loaf (10 slices) • Prep: 15 minutes • Cook: 60 minutes

Ingredients:

— 3 very ripe bananas, mashed (about 1 1/4 cups)
— 1/3 cup unsalted butter, melted
— 3/4 cup sugar
— 1 egg, beaten
— 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
— 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
— 1 teaspoon baking soda
— 1/4 teaspoon salt
— 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon
— 1/2 cup chopped walnuts or pecans (optional)

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Grease a 9x5-inch loaf pan.
2. In a large bowl, stir the melted butter into the mashed bananas until well combined.
3. Stir in the sugar, beaten egg, and vanilla extract.
4. Sprinkle the flour, baking soda, salt, and cinnamon over the banana mixture. Stir until just combined. Do not overmix.
5. Fold in the nuts, if using.
6. Pour the batter into the prepared loaf pan. Bake for 55 to 65 minutes, until a toothpick inserted into the center comes out clean.
7. Let the bread cool in the pan for 10 minutes, then turn out onto a wire rack to cool completely before slicing.

Note:

The riper the bananas, the sweeter and more flavorful the bread. Bananas with black skins are ideal. The bread keeps well wrapped at room temperature for up to 4 days.

New England Clam Chowder

Yield: 6 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 35 minutes

Ingredients:

— 4 slices thick-cut bacon, cut into 1/2-inch pieces
— 1 large onion, diced
— 3 stalks celery, diced
— 3 cloves garlic, minced
— 1/3 cup all-purpose flour
— 2 cups bottled clam juice
— 2 cups low-sodium chicken broth
— 1 1/2 pounds Yukon gold potatoes, peeled and cut into 1/2-inch cubes
— 3 cans (6.5 oz each) chopped clams, drained, juice reserved
— 1 cup heavy cream
— 1/2 cup whole milk
— 1 teaspoon dried thyme
— 2 bay leaves
— Salt and black pepper to taste
— Fresh chives, for garnish

Instructions:

1. Cook the bacon in a large pot over medium heat until crispy. Transfer to a paper-towel-lined plate, leaving the drippings in the pot.
2. Add the onion and celery to the pot. Cook over medium heat, stirring occasionally, until softened, about 5 minutes. Add the garlic and cook 1 minute more.
3. Sprinkle the flour over the vegetables and stir to coat. Cook for 2 minutes, stirring constantly.
4. Gradually stir in the clam juice, chicken broth, and reserved clam liquid. Add the potatoes, thyme, and bay leaves.
5. Bring to a boil, then reduce heat to medium-low. Simmer, stirring occasionally, until the potatoes are tender, about 15 minutes.

6. Stir in the heavy cream, milk, and drained clams. Heat gently until just simmering. Do not boil.
7. Remove the bay leaves. Season with salt and pepper. Serve topped with the reserved crispy bacon and fresh chives.

Note:

Do not boil the chowder after adding the cream or the dairy may break. The chowder thickens as it sits.

Classic American Meatloaf

Yield: 6 to 8 servings • Prep: 15 minutes • Cook: 1 hour

Ingredients:

— 2 pounds ground beef (80/20 blend)
— 1 medium onion, finely diced
— 3 cloves garlic, minced
— 2 eggs, beaten
— 1/2 cup whole milk
— 1 cup plain breadcrumbs
— 1/4 cup fresh parsley, chopped
— 2 tablespoons Worcestershire sauce
— 1 teaspoon salt
— 1/2 teaspoon black pepper
— 1/2 teaspoon dried thyme
— 1/2 cup ketchup
— 2 tablespoons brown sugar
— 1 tablespoon apple cider vinegar

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 350 degrees F. Line a rimmed baking sheet with foil and lightly oil it.
2. In a large bowl, combine the ground beef, onion, garlic, eggs, milk, breadcrumbs, parsley, Worcestershire sauce, salt, pepper, and thyme.
3. Using clean hands, mix gently just until everything is evenly combined. Overmixing makes meatloaf tough.
4. Shape the mixture into a 9x5-inch loaf on the prepared baking sheet.
5. In a small bowl, whisk together the ketchup, brown sugar, and vinegar to make the glaze.
6. Spread half of the glaze over the top of the loaf.
7. Bake for 30 minutes, then spread the remaining glaze over the top. Continue baking for 25 to 30 minutes more, until the internal temperature reaches 160 degrees F.

8. Let the meatloaf rest for 10 minutes before slicing and serving.

Note:

Using a baking sheet instead of a loaf pan allows the sides to caramelize for more flavorful results.

Loaded Baked Potato Soup

Yield: 6 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 35 minutes

Ingredients:

— 6 strips bacon, cut into 1-inch pieces
— 1 large onion, diced
— 4 cloves garlic, minced
— 3 tablespoons all-purpose flour
— 4 cups low-sodium chicken broth
— 2 pounds russet potatoes, peeled and cut into 1/2-inch cubes
— 1 cup sour cream
— 1 cup whole milk
— 1 1/2 cups sharp cheddar cheese, shredded
— Salt and black pepper to taste
— Sliced green onions, for serving
— Extra sour cream and cheddar, for serving

Instructions:

1. Cook the bacon in a large pot over medium heat until crispy. Remove with a slotted spoon and set aside. Drain all but 2 tablespoons of drippings.
2. Add the onion to the pot and cook over medium heat until softened, about 5 minutes. Add the garlic and cook 1 minute more.
3. Sprinkle the flour over the onion and stir to coat. Cook, stirring, for 2 minutes.
4. Gradually stir in the chicken broth. Add the potatoes and bring to a boil.
5. Reduce heat and simmer until the potatoes are very tender, about 15 to 20 minutes.
6. Use a potato masher to partially mash the potatoes directly in the pot, leaving some chunks for texture.
7. Stir in the sour cream and milk. Heat gently over low heat. Add 1 cup of the cheddar cheese and stir until melted. Do not boil.
8. Season with salt and pepper. Serve topped with the remaining cheese, crispy bacon, and green onions.

Note:

For a smoother soup, blend a portion of it in a blender before adding the dairy.

Old-Fashioned Peach Cobbler

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 45 minutes

Ingredients:

— 3 pounds fresh peaches, peeled and sliced, or 2 bags (20 oz each) frozen sliced peaches, thawed

— 3/4 cup plus 2 tablespoons sugar, divided

— 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice

— 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon

— 1/4 teaspoon ground nutmeg

— 1/2 cup unsalted butter

— 1 cup all-purpose flour

— 1 1/2 teaspoons baking powder

— 1/4 teaspoon salt

— 1 cup whole milk

— 1 teaspoon vanilla extract

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 375 degrees F.
2. Toss the peaches with 1/4 cup of the sugar, lemon juice, cinnamon, and nutmeg in a bowl. Set aside.
3. Place the butter in a 9x13-inch baking dish and put it in the oven to melt, about 5 minutes. Remove when melted.
4. In a medium bowl, whisk together the flour, remaining 1/2 cup plus 2 tablespoons sugar, baking powder, and salt. Stir in the milk and vanilla until a smooth batter forms.
5. Pour the batter over the melted butter in the baking dish. Do not stir.
6. Spoon the peach mixture evenly over the batter. Do not stir — the batter will rise up around the peaches as it bakes.
7. Bake for 40 to 45 minutes, until the topping is golden brown and the edges are bubbling.
8. Serve warm with a scoop of vanilla ice cream or a dollop of whipped cream.

Note:

The batter rises up around and through the fruit during baking, creating a tender, cake-like crust. Do not stir after assembly.

Southern Fried Chicken

Yield: 4 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 40 minutes

Ingredients:

— 1 whole chicken (3 1/2 pounds), cut into 8 pieces, or 8 bone-in, skin-on chicken pieces
— 2 cups buttermilk
— 1 teaspoon hot sauce
— 2 cups all-purpose flour
— 1/2 cup cornstarch
— 2 teaspoons salt
— 1 teaspoon black pepper
— 1 teaspoon garlic powder
— 1 teaspoon onion powder
— 1 teaspoon smoked paprika
— 1/2 teaspoon cayenne pepper
— Vegetable oil or lard, for frying (about 3 cups)

Instructions:

1. Combine the buttermilk and hot sauce in a large bowl. Add the chicken pieces and toss to coat. Cover and refrigerate for at least 4 hours, or overnight.
2. In a shallow dish, whisk together the flour, cornstarch, salt, pepper, garlic powder, onion powder, paprika, and cayenne.
3. Remove the chicken from the buttermilk, letting excess drip off. Dredge each piece in the flour mixture, pressing firmly so the coating adheres. Shake off any excess.
4. Pour the oil into a large cast iron skillet or Dutch oven to a depth of about 1 1/2 inches. Heat to 350 degrees F.
5. Working in batches, add the chicken pieces skin-side down. Do not crowd the pan. Fry for 12 to 14 minutes per side, until the crust is deep golden brown and the internal temperature reaches 165 degrees F.
6. Transfer the fried chicken to a wire rack set over a baking sheet to drain. Do not place on paper towels, which trap steam.

7. Serve hot or at room temperature.

Note:

Maintaining an oil temperature between 325 and 350 degrees F throughout frying is the key to crispy, juicy chicken.

Old-Fashioned Pumpkin Pie

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 1 hour

Ingredients:

— 1 unbaked 9-inch pie crust
— 1 can (15 oz) pure pumpkin puree
— 3/4 cup packed light brown sugar
— 3 eggs
— 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
— 1/2 teaspoon ground ginger
— 1/4 teaspoon ground cloves
— 1/4 teaspoon ground nutmeg
— 1/2 teaspoon salt
— 1 cup heavy cream
— 1/2 cup whole milk

Instructions:

1. Preheat the oven to 375 degrees F. Press the pie crust into a 9-inch pie plate and crimp the edges decoratively. Refrigerate while you make the filling.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the pumpkin puree, brown sugar, eggs, cinnamon, ginger, cloves, nutmeg, and salt until smooth.
3. Whisk in the heavy cream and milk until the filling is well combined and uniform.
4. Pour the filling into the chilled pie shell.
5. Bake for 55 to 65 minutes, until the filling is set around the edges but still slightly wobbly in the very center.
6. Transfer to a wire rack and cool completely, at least 2 hours, before slicing.
7. Serve at room temperature or chilled with a generous dollop of freshly whipped cream.

Note:

The pie continues to set as it cools. It will keep covered in the refrigerator for up to 3 days.

Blueberry Muffins

Yield: 12 muffins • Prep: 15 minutes • Cook: 22 minutes

Ingredients:

— 2 cups all-purpose flour
— 2/3 cup sugar, plus 2 tablespoons for topping
— 2 teaspoons baking powder
— 1/2 teaspoon baking soda
— 1/2 teaspoon salt
— 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon
— 1/2 cup unsalted butter, melted and cooled
— 2 eggs
— 3/4 cup whole milk
— 1/4 cup sour cream
— 1 1/2 teaspoons vanilla extract
— 2 cups fresh or frozen blueberries (do not thaw if frozen)

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 400 degrees F. Line a 12-cup muffin tin with paper liners.
2. In a large bowl, whisk together the flour, 2/3 cup sugar, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and cinnamon.
3. In a separate bowl, whisk together the melted butter, eggs, milk, sour cream, and vanilla extract.
4. Pour the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients and fold gently until just combined. The batter will be lumpy.
5. Fold in the blueberries gently. Do not overmix.
6. Divide the batter evenly among the muffin cups, filling each about 3/4 full. Sprinkle the tops with the remaining 2 tablespoons of sugar.
7. Bake for 18 to 22 minutes, until the tops are golden and a toothpick inserted in the center comes out clean.
8. Cool in the pan for 5 minutes, then transfer to a wire rack. Serve warm or at room temperature.

Note:

Tossing the blueberries in a tablespoon of flour before adding them to the batter helps prevent them from sinking.

Roast Turkey with Herb Butter

Yield: 10 to 12 servings • Prep: 30 minutes • Cook: 3 hours 30 minutes

Ingredients:

— 1 whole turkey (12 to 14 pounds), thawed if frozen
— 6 tablespoons unsalted butter, softened
— 2 tablespoons fresh thyme, minced
— 1 tablespoon fresh rosemary, minced
— 1 tablespoon fresh sage, minced
— 3 cloves garlic, minced
— 2 teaspoons salt
— 1 teaspoon black pepper
— 1 large onion, quartered
— 1 lemon, halved
— 1 head garlic, halved crosswise
— 4 sprigs fresh thyme
— 2 cups low-sodium chicken or turkey broth

Instructions:

1. Remove the turkey from the refrigerator 1 hour before roasting. Remove the neck and giblets and reserve for gravy. Pat the turkey dry with paper towels.
2. Preheat the oven to 325 degrees F.
3. Combine the softened butter, minced thyme, rosemary, sage, garlic, salt, and pepper in a small bowl.
4. Loosen the skin over the breast and thighs by gently running your hand under it. Spread half of the herb butter directly onto the meat under the skin. Rub the remaining herb butter all over the outside of the turkey.
5. Season the cavity with salt and pepper and fill with the quartered onion, lemon halves, halved garlic head, and thyme sprigs.
6. Place the turkey breast-side up on a rack in a large roasting pan. Pour the broth into the pan.

7. Roast for 2 1/2 to 3 1/2 hours, basting with the pan juices every 45 minutes, until a thermometer inserted in the thickest part of the thigh reads 165 degrees F.
8. Tent loosely with foil and rest for 30 minutes before carving.

Note:

Allow 13 minutes of roasting time per pound for an unstuffed turkey at 325 degrees F.

Sweet Potato Casserole

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 45 minutes

Ingredients:

— 3 pounds sweet potatoes, peeled and cut into 2-inch chunks
— 1/3 cup unsalted butter, softened
— 1/3 cup whole milk
— 1/3 cup packed light brown sugar
— 2 eggs, beaten
— 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
— 1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
— 1/2 teaspoon ground nutmeg
— 1/2 teaspoon salt
— 1 cup chopped pecans
— 1/2 cup packed light brown sugar
— 1/3 cup all-purpose flour
— 3 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 350 degrees F. Butter a 9x13-inch baking dish.
2. Boil the sweet potatoes in salted water until very tender, about 15 minutes. Drain well.
3. Mash the sweet potatoes until smooth. Beat in the softened butter, milk, 1/3 cup brown sugar, eggs, vanilla, cinnamon, nutmeg, and salt until light and fluffy.
4. Spread the sweet potato mixture evenly in the prepared baking dish.
5. Make the pecan topping: stir together the pecans, 1/2 cup brown sugar, flour, and melted butter until crumbly. Sprinkle evenly over the sweet potatoes.
6. Bake for 30 to 35 minutes, until the topping is golden brown and the filling is heated through and set.
7. Let stand for 5 minutes before serving.

Note:

This casserole can be assembled up to a day in advance. Add the topping just before baking. Great alongside roast turkey or ham.

Fluffy Buttermilk Pancakes

Yield: 4 servings (about 12 pancakes) • Prep: 10 minutes • Cook: 20 minutes

Ingredients:

— 2 cups all-purpose flour
— 2 tablespoons sugar
— 2 teaspoons baking powder
— 1 teaspoon baking soda
— 1/2 teaspoon salt
— 2 cups buttermilk
— 2 eggs
— 3 tablespoons unsalted butter, melted and cooled
— 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
— Butter and maple syrup, for serving

Instructions:

1. In a large bowl, whisk together the flour, sugar, baking powder, baking soda, and salt.
2. In a separate bowl, whisk together the buttermilk, eggs, melted butter, and vanilla extract.
3. Pour the wet ingredients into the dry ingredients and fold gently until just combined. Do not overmix — lumps are okay and will cook out.
4. Let the batter rest for 5 minutes while you heat a griddle or large nonstick skillet over medium heat.
5. Lightly grease the griddle with butter. Pour about 1/4 cup of batter per pancake onto the griddle.
6. Cook until bubbles form across the surface of the pancakes and the edges look set, about 2 to 3 minutes. Flip and cook until golden on the second side, about 1 to 2 minutes more.
7. Serve immediately with butter and warm maple syrup.

Note:

The baking soda reacts with the buttermilk to create the signature fluffy texture. Do not substitute regular milk without also adjusting the leavening.

Classic Lemon Pound Cake

Yield: 12 slices • Prep: 20 minutes • Cook: 1 hour 10 minutes

Ingredients:

— 1 1/2 cups unsalted butter, softened
— 2 1/2 cups sugar, divided
— 6 eggs, room temperature
— 2 tablespoons lemon zest (from about 3 lemons)
— 3 tablespoons fresh lemon juice, plus 1/4 cup for the glaze
— 1 teaspoon vanilla extract
— 3 cups all-purpose flour
— 1/2 teaspoon baking soda
— 1/2 teaspoon salt
— 1 cup full-fat sour cream
— 1 cup powdered sugar

Instructions:

1. Preheat oven to 325 degrees F. Grease and flour a 12-cup bundt pan.
2. Beat the butter and 2 cups of the sugar in a stand mixer on medium-high speed until very light and fluffy, about 5 minutes.
3. Add the eggs one at a time, beating well after each. Scrape down the bowl. Beat in the lemon zest, 3 tablespoons lemon juice, and vanilla.
4. In a separate bowl, whisk together the flour, baking soda, and salt.
5. With the mixer on low, alternate adding the flour mixture and sour cream in three additions each, beginning and ending with the flour. Mix until just combined.
6. Pour the batter into the prepared pan. Bake for 65 to 75 minutes, until a wooden skewer inserted in the center comes out clean.
7. Cool in the pan for 15 minutes, then invert onto a wire rack.
8. While the cake is still warm, stir together the powdered sugar and remaining 1/4 cup lemon juice to make the glaze. Drizzle over the warm cake. Cool completely before slicing.

Note:

Room temperature butter and eggs are essential for a properly emulsified batter and a fine, even crumb.

Yankee White Bean Soup

Yield: 8 servings • Prep: 15 minutes • Cook: 2 hours 30 minutes

Ingredients:

— 1 pound dried Great Northern or navy beans, sorted and rinsed
— 1 smoked ham hock or 1 cup diced ham
— 1 large onion, diced
— 3 stalks celery, diced
— 2 medium carrots, diced
— 4 cloves garlic, minced
— 2 bay leaves
— 1 teaspoon dried thyme
— 8 cups water or low-sodium chicken broth
— Salt and black pepper to taste
— 2 tablespoons fresh parsley, chopped

Instructions:

1. Soak the beans overnight in a large bowl with enough cold water to cover by 3 inches. Drain and rinse.
2. Combine the soaked beans, ham hock, onion, celery, carrots, garlic, bay leaves, thyme, and water or broth in a large pot.
3. Bring to a boil over high heat, skimming off any foam that rises to the surface.
4. Reduce heat to low, partially cover the pot, and simmer gently for 1 1/2 to 2 hours, until the beans are very tender.
5. Remove the ham hock. When cool enough to handle, shred any meat from the bone and return it to the pot. Discard the bone and skin.
6. Remove the bay leaves. Using a ladle or large spoon, mash some of the beans against the side of the pot to thicken the soup.
7. Season generously with salt and pepper. Serve hot, garnished with fresh parsley.

Note:

If you are short on time, substitute 3 cans (15 oz each) of drained white beans and reduce the simmering time to 30 minutes.